

The Almonte Gazette

Vol. 41, 123rd Year

October 10, 1990

60 cents

Off and running

United Way campaign forges ahead into October



By Ryland Coyne
Gazette news editor

With the successful Velobus kick-off event behind them, local United Way organizers want to remind residents not to forget their donations this month.

Each household in town will be receiving a mailer early this month asking for a donation. This year's goal is \$110,000 in Lanark County, with the money going to nine designated community groups.

Almonte organizer Bob Burns said residents can make their donations at either the Royal Bank or the Bank of Montreal. Both institutions are prepared to issue tax receipts for donations of \$10 or more. Otherwise, residents can send their donations to the United Way, P.O. Box 442 in Smiths Falls, K7A 4T4.

He added that with a large contingent of the Almonte population working in Ottawa, people who give at their workplace can designate their donation for Lanark County. The "Give Where You Live" campaign was effective last year in allowing Lanark County to reach its \$110,000 goal. By not specifying where the donation is to go, Mr. Burns said the money goes directly to the United Way of Ottawa-Carleton.

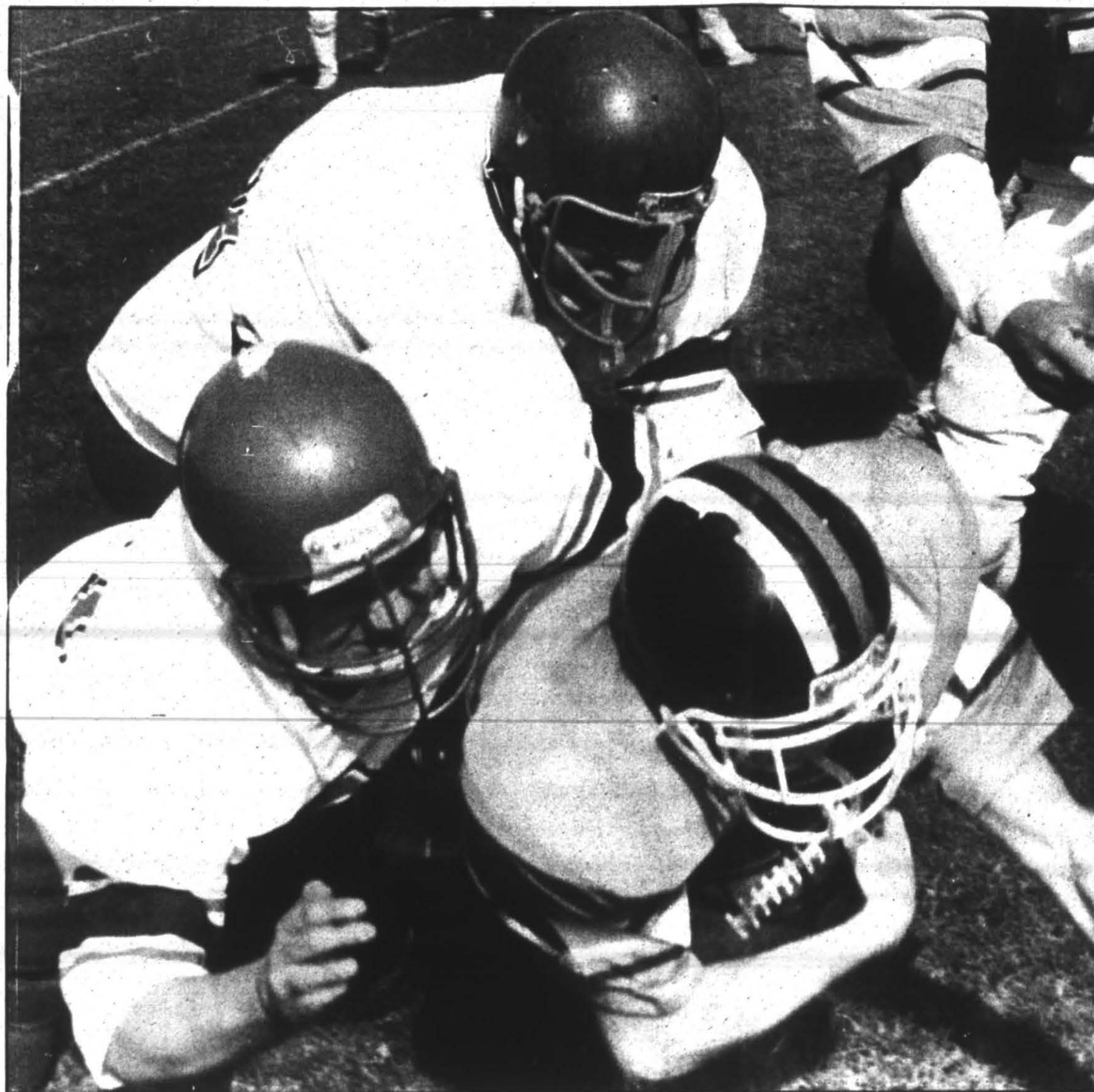
While the local public is encouraged to donate through the mail, businesses in town will be canvassed face-to-face. Almonte Royal Bank manager Ernie Preston hit the downtown streets last week and will continue as volunteer canvasser throughout October.

The 1990 United appeal runs through until the first week of November.

Member group here in Almonte

One of those non-profit groups on the United Way list, the Almonte-Ramsay Seniors Home Support, is set up here in this community. The two-year old project helps local seniors live independently in their own homes. Like the other eight agencies sponsored by the United Way, the home support depends largely on volunteers to assist with such jobs as telephone assurance, medical transportation and Meals on Wheels.

Other groups that depend largely on the United Way include the Big Brothers/Big Sisters, the Canadian National Institute for the Blind (CNIB), Lanark County Therapeutic Riding Program, and the Family and Children's Services Teen Support Program.



Going down!

Crunch! Almonte Senior Thunderbolt Rob Drynan is brought down by two Arnprior Redmen after picking up good yardage. The Orange and Black clobbered the

Redmen 42-6 running their record to a perfect 4-0 this season. The game was played in conjunction with the first Thunderbolt reunion held Saturday night. Photo by June Dalgity.

Thunderbolts reunion/Terry Currie roast bring back many memories

Event raised money for high school gym expansion

By John LeVatte
Gazette reporter

By the time it was Terry Currie's turn to speak a few words during the weekend Thunderbolt reunion there was very little left to say.

Currie, who has been involved in coaching at Almonte High School for 25 years, was toasted, roasted and honored and when it was over, he summed up the feeling of the weekend beautifully.

"Do you know what it's like when you go to the perfect party?" he asked the almost 200 in attendance for the reunion dinner and dance, "it's when you go to a party where you know and like everyone who's there and that's what this party has been for me. Thank you," he said.

With those words Currie put the finishing touches on a celebration that saw past present and maybe even future Thunderbolts gather to tell a few tall tales, swap stories of coach Currie and most of all

enjoy themselves immensely.

Reunion chairman June Dalgity called the event a complete success.

"Oh yeah, It was great I'm really

and dinner and of course the roast of coach Currie.

"I was so busy that day I didn't have time to think about anything and when they

"...when they called me up there I almost fell off my chair."

--Terry Currie
Thunderbolt toastee



pleased," she said.

Although the final tally is not in yet, the reunion is expected to go a long way in aiding in the construction of a new gymnasium at the high school.

Highlights for the weekend included a Thunderbolts football game on Saturday afternoon that saw the current edition of the team destroy the Arnprior Redmen 42-6.

The game was followed by a social hour

called me up there I just about fell off my chair," said Currie.

The coach admits that he is now a "soft-spoken old gentleman" and said at one time he was a little more "peppery" which earned him the nickname of "Terrible" Terry Currie.

Calling the roaster's comments "lying cheap shots" Currie said one roast com-

See Reunion page 3

Temporary repairs to the curling rink roof should save 1990-91 season

By Ryland Coyne
Gazette news editor

An Ottawa construction company and the town have found a practical if only temporary solution to the leaking curling rink roof that should save the upcoming season from certain delay.

BBS Construction (Ont.) Ltd. has installed a series of drip panels near the ceiling above sheets one and two. The panels will intercept the water before it hits the playing surface and divert it into 40 gallon buckets placed at various intervals along the west wall.

Almonte clerk-treasurer Des Houston said Friday with curling season just around the corner the move, which will cost the town \$3,300, was necessary.

"Everybody's anxious to see this thing resolved. This will divert the water on a temporary basis and get the curlers going," he said.

In an interview last month, Almonte recreation director Jack McKay said ice would be going in at the hockey arena sometime this week. Ice at the curling facility would go in by mid-October.

But a report released two weeks ago said the leaky roof, which plagued local curlers all last season, could cost upwards of \$100,000 to fix properly.

Faced with months of legal wrangling with the bonding company over the hefty estimate, Mr. Houston said it became clear to town officials "permanent repairs" would not be able to be made until next year.

"Negotiations don't happen overnight,"

he said. "It took quite a while just to get the report."

"With these temporary repairs, the ice will be installed and there will be no delay in the 1990-91 curling season."

Although the work began Friday, Almonte council was expected to approve the \$3,300 cost at last night's monthly meeting.

Curling club concerned

Angry members of the local curling club also approached the town with concerns that a delay in the upcoming year could cost them members.

"We definitely were concerned about the continuing delays on the roof," said club president Moe Rowsom in an interview Monday.

He attributed the lack of response to the club membership drive to "uncertainty" over whether or not the season would get underway on schedule. "People won't commit themselves" until they hear steps have been taken to rectify the situation, Mr. Rowsom said.

While he noted he's "pleased that we'll be able to curl", he added that the measures in place are not ideal.

Still, with the panels now in place and the season back on the rails, he said a more concerted effort will be made over the next couple of weeks to attract members before curling begins in earnest Oct. 21.

The panels were expected to be completed by today (Wednesday).

Small crowds, large media attend events at first ever "Textile week"

By Lois Tuffin
Gazette reporter

Alex Hughes said if nothing else, textile industry awareness week taught its organizers what they had done wrong.

Although the past week's events drew heavy media coverage, small crowds, mainly from out of town, materialized, according to the president of the Mississippi Valley Textile Museum.

Office manager Jo Crivellaro said 177 people signed the guest book set up in the annex of the proposed museum site over the weekend, and estimated close to 200 visited the site, most of them on Sunday. She said more were expected.

"The timing was bad," Mr. Hughes added, referring to the choice of Thanksgiving weekend, the same time invited guests of the textile industry were attending a symposium in Germany. Ms. Crivellaro said "key" government employees from Toronto did not appear.

Also, of the Coleman Island residents invited to express their concerns about living next to the museum Friday

afternoon, one showed up.

He added weekend visitors came from locations like Smiths Falls, Brockville and Ottawa. "Almonte takes it for granted," he said.

Ms. Crivellaro said she figured the museum board broke even, which she said was not a concern since the week was designed to promote awareness of the project's progress.

While local interest may be low, that of the media was not. The editor of the Textile Journal visited the project, as did McLean-Hunter TV. CJOH broadcast their weekend weather report from the former Rosamond Mill annex, while the CBC interviewed former mill workers.

Mr. Hughes said the major accomplishment was getting everything, including the annex, ready in time. He credited Ms. Crivellaro and volunteer Christine Kartson-Burns with pulling things together with very little lead time.

He added his group learned its members would have to give themselves more time to organize if the awareness campaign becomes an annual event.

In focus



Hair away!

Almonte electrologist Jean Morgan pampers women in her Euphemia Street salon, offering many services including hair removal.

-- Please see page 7

Index

Heritage column.....page 3
EAC.....page 4
Editorial.....pages 4 and 5
In and About.....page 6
Community Living.....page 7
Sports.....pages 8 and 9
Classifieds.....pages 12 and 13
Real Estate.....page 14

Gearing up for Christmas

Almonte merchants plan 'Light up the Town' promotion Nov. 16

By Lois Tuffin
Gazette reporter

The Almonte Business Improvement Association (BIA) is already thinking Christmas...Christmas shopping that is.

A BIA committee is finalizing details for the "Light up the Town" weekend, Nov. 16 to 18, which its members hope will draw shoppers from here and from out of town to local businesses. The out of town promotion carries the slogan "Santa spoken here," according to committee member Gina Stewart.

Committee chairperson Pat Vetter said

she is counting on participation from several factions.

Merchants are being encouraged to dress up Mill Street with window displays and period costumes, and to open their businesses Sunday afternoon for the special weekend.

Auxiliaries from the Almonte General Hospital and the Children's Hospital of Eastern Ontario (CHEO) each plan to decorate their own six-foot Christmas trees, then raffle them off in early December. The trees, with Victorian and country decorating themes respectively,

will be on display downtown before the draw.

Schoolchildren are being called on to decorate two trees in front of the Royal Bank. While the BIA will supply the lights, each local school has been asked to generate other decorations. Mrs. Vetter said she is still looking for more hands to help.

Shoppers, in turn, are asked to make a contribution towards decorations via the boxes placed in several stores. For each dollar donated, a person receives a "personalized Christmas tree bulb," a slip of

paper with a sketch of a light and the buyer's name on it, hanging on one of the trees along the main street.

Mrs. Stewart pointed out these funds don't cover all the BIA's costs, but helps replace broken lights, maintain old ones and buy new ones to enlarge the lighted area. One portion of Mill Street went unlit last year, something the committee hopes to change in 1990.

Scheduled festivities begin 6:30 p.m. Friday (Nov. 16) with a warm-up reception.

See Light page 3

Almonte-Carleton Place gasoline prices just keep CLIMBING

By John LeVatte
Gazette Reporter

Economists and oil industry officials are saying that unless the Persian Gulf Crisis is resolved quickly, the latest increase of three cents per litre of regular unleaded gas may be just the first in a long-line of energy price hikes in store for Canadians in the coming months.

Prices in the Carleton Place area rose sharply early last Wednesday morning (Oct. 3) from their former \$9.4 to the current \$9.7 for regular unleaded gasoline.

John Hunt, spokesman for Petro-Canada in Calgary, said the government-owned company has raised its prices to match its competitors' per litre mark in order to recoup its higher payout for world crude prices.

An employee at Bill's Esso on Hwy. 7 in Carleton Place said the station's price for regular unleaded gas is set by company officials in Toronto and currently stands at \$9.7.

She said, although prices range from as high as \$9.9 to a low of \$9.4 in the Carleton Place-Almonte area, they should remain in the same price range as local dealers maintain close competition.

Many people have speculated that the major oil companies are simply taking advantage of the current mid-east situation.

And according to Dr. Maurice Ruel, director general of the federal government's oil and gas branch of Energy Mines and Resources, there is no current shortage of crude oil on the world market.



The numbers tell the story.

But Ruel said, because the market is not regulated, speculators often drive the price up uncontrollably.

He said both Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) and non-OPEC nations have picked up production to lessen the impact on the world market. As well, Ruel said countries have already begun to reduce their usage of oil.

"The situation is tight right now but it is manageable," said Ruel who added that, barring any "unforeseen" hostilities in the Gulf region, the price should drop to a more reasonable level.

But Ruel warns that, if the upcoming winter is unusually harsh or if there are any accidents like the Exxon Valdez tragedy in 1989, prices could rise further regardless of developments in the Gulf.

"Meet our new staff member"

The Gazette welcomes reporter John LeVatte aboard as the newest addition to our news gathering staff.

John comes to us as a former reporter with The Smiths Falls Record News and, more recently, as a regular correspondent with The Ottawa Citizen.



Gazette reporter John LeVatte peruses the sports pages.

A graduate of the print journalism course at Loyalist College in Belleville, John is a resident of Smiths Falls where he and his wife Crystal are awaiting the birth of their first child.

John's professional interests include politics and business and, on the personal front, he enjoys playing hockey, reading and music.